

Boston Sunday Globe

Serving our community since 1872

MAY 25, 2025

Holy Father, distant cousin?

Reporter's roundabout relation to Leo XIV is a uniquely American history

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

Just hours after Pope Leo XIV (born Robert Francis Prevost in Chicago) made history as the first head of the Catholic Church from the United States, my aunt sent a Facebook post to our family group chat. It claimed the pope — who, at that point, was only known to have European ancestry — had “Creole of color roots from New Orleans on his mother’s side.”

As a Black Creole from a New Orleans Catholic family, I was excited. But as a journalist, I was skeptical. In moments of high public interest, misinformation tends to



GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION; AP PHOTO

spread. But then my hometown newspaper wrote about it. Next came The New York Times, which ran a photo of the gravestone of Leo’s maternal grandparents in Illinois.

But they weren’t buried alone. Other members of their extended family were also interred there and memorialized on the gravestone. Any doubt I had about the veracity of the pope’s Creole heritage evaporated when I read my last name at the bottom of that gravestone.

Growing up with a last name as unique as Sorapuru — or “Soraparu,” as it’s spelled on the gravestone — my family always told me that if someone else shared it,

POPE, Page A17

A sudden turn on the road ahead

On the eve of high school graduation, a Vermont family opts to self-deport



STORY BY GIULIA McDONNELL NIETO DEL RIO | PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI | GLOBE STAFF

The high school auditorium was unusually empty for a graduation: just two students in bright red caps and gowns, sitting side by side at the front. The small crowd that had gathered sat scattered across the room. It was mid-April, early for a high school graduation in Northwestern Vermont.

The two seniors, sisters Andrea and Nahomy Chavarría, would not be here for the school’s official commencement in June. They were immigrants from Nicaragua, and given the political tenor under President Trump and what could be the imminent loss of their legal status, their family had elected to self-deport.

So Champlain Valley Union High School, in Hinesburg, threw them an

early ceremony. And despite the absence of the usual pomp — live bands, news crews, valedictorian speeches — the sisters brought their own energy, whooping with cheers as each took a turn across the stage to collect her diploma. Teachers praised their academic and personal achievements in speeches they had prepared, just for the girls.

In a quiet moment after the ceremony, Andrea, 19, reflected on the words of comfort the two heard from their teachers and friends. “They always say: ‘I wish you could stay.’” She then paused for a moment.

“Wow, I feel like it’s just ... an end.”

The Chavarría family came to the United States legally in 2024 during one of the largest immigration surges

NICARAGUA, Page A14



Top, Andrea Chavarría (left) and her sister Nahomy sat together during a graduation ceremony just for them. Amid the current political tenor, the family decided to return to Nicaragua. Above, the teens at the airport.

Behind Harvard feud, an old score

Trump had a long beef with family of senior official Penny Pritzker

By Mark Arsenault and Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF
and Shirley Leung
GLOBE COLUMNIST

It was three-plus decades ago, after their partnership in a hotel at New York’s Grand Central Station went bad, that developer Donald J. Trump swore revenge on the Pritzker family.

“They attacked me when I was down,” Trump said in 1993 about the Pritzkers, the wealthy Chicago family behind the Hyatt hotel brand. “I always said, the first time I got back on my feet, the Pritzkers would be the first people I’d go after.”

Go after them Trump did, in a \$500 million lawsuit accusing his partners in the New York Grand Hyatt hotel of fraud and extortion. The Pritzkers sued back, claiming that Trump failed to pay his share for renovations to the property, and ultimately bought Trump out of the hotel in 1996.

PRITZKER, Page A12

Students in the crosshairs

At Northeastern and other US colleges, international students nervous Harvard ban may widen to more campuses. **A11, B1.**

Adding up progress on racial equity

\$1 billion pledged after death of George Floyd

By Tiana Woodard
GLOBE STAFF

Five years ago, the 8-minute, 46-second smartphone video of George Floyd’s murder upended the long frustrating campaign for racial equity. The recorded death by Minneapolis police tugged at people’s hearts, anger, and ultimately, their wallets.

In the months that followed, organizations across the country made sweeping proclamations of antiracism, pledging to give billions upon billions to initiatives to combat racism and end violence and injustice on Black communities.

In Greater Boston, at least 20 foundations, organizations, and corporations pledged about \$1 billion in grants, investments, and scholarships for equity-related causes, according to a Globe review of announcements in response to the racial reckoning of 2020. They variously aimed at reducing disparities in health and

PHILANTHROPY, Page A16

VOL. 307, NO. 145

*

Suggested retail price
\$6.00

Mower and mower

Sunday: Breezy. High: 61-66. Low: 49-54.

Monday: Partly sunny. High: 62-67. Low: 51-56.

High tide: 10:10 a.m. 10:26 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:14 Sunset: 8:09

Complete report, **A24.** Deaths, **A18-23.**

The ICA Watershed presents Berlin-based artist Chiharu Shiota’s installation of dangling ropes, airborne suitcases, and domestic comforts, evoking an unsettled world. **SundayArts, N1.**

After the Celtics’ loss, Dan Shaughnessy asks whether we are losers once again. **Sports, C1.**

Robert Macfarlane’s new book ponders the rights and wonders of the world’s waterways. **Books, N9.**

Summer is Cape Cod season. Here are some Cape must-do’s. **Travel, N11.**

The Globe Magazine is not publishing today. The puzzles can be found on **B4.**



A Memorable Rate.

6-MONTH CD SPECIAL

4.40 %
APY*

AVAILABLE FOR PERSONAL AND BUSINESS ACCOUNTS

Open an account today
at institutionforsavings.com.



Thank you to all who have served.



INSTITUTION FOR SAVINGS

BUILDING STRONGER COMMUNITIES TOGETHER SINCE 1820.

978-462-3106 • institutionforsavings.com

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is effective 5/21/25. Term deposit rates and APYs are fixed for the duration of the term. Minimum balance to open an account and obtain the Annual Percentage Yield shown is \$500. A penalty will be imposed for early withdrawal. Account is available for personal and business accounts. Rates are subject to change. Deposits insured in full. Member FDIC • Member DIF